Matt Estes

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Executive leader in learning, talent, *and capability.*

Senior Director, Learning, Talent, and Capability at Vanderbilt University. Twenty years leading enterprise learning, leadership development, and talent systems across higher education, healthcare, and global business, and building the capability organizations need for an AI-enabled workforce.

Enterprise learning strategy | Leadership education | Talent and skills architecture | AI-enabled workforce

CAREER

Two decades of building *capability.*

Vanderbilt University

2024 – Present **Now**

Senior Director, Learning, Talent, and Capability — Jul 2026 – Present

Director, Learning Innovation and Impact — Jul 2024 – Jul 2026

I lead the university's enterprise learning, talent, and capability strategy: the systems and solutions that help people grow, develop, and do their best work in an AI-enabled world.

- Set the enterprise learning, talent, and capability agenda and align it with institutional goals, workforce needs, and future capability demands.
- Built an AI-forward learning ecosystem using generative and agentic AI, an LXP, the LMS, and automation to deliver development in the flow of work.
- Put a skills-based job architecture to work behind a skills-driven talent marketplace, role-based learning paths, and internal mobility.
- Designed AI-augmented development models that speed up content creation and personalize learning at scale.
- Built leadership and manager programs that strengthen performance management, communication, and accountability.
- Created KPIs, ROI measures, and AI-assisted dashboards that turn workforce signals into executive insight.

LEAD3R

2023 – 2024

Remote

Director, Leader Effectiveness — Nov 2023 – Jul 2024

I architected leadership development for international clients, pairing human-centered design with digital-first delivery to drive measurable leadership capability.

- Led cross-cultural leadership cohorts across Asia, Europe, and North America, including a Japan-based cohort adapted for local context.
- Designed digital-first leadership journeys with AI-guided reflection, mobile-first modules, and collaborative virtual work.
- Shaped growth-aligned RFP strategy that expanded the client pipeline and contributed to new partnerships.
- Built evidence-based feedback loops to keep programs relevant, inclusive, and grounded in data.

Cityblock Health

2021 – 2023

A Google-backed healthcare company

Director of Learning Systems and Innovation — Feb 2023 – Jun 2023

Interim Vice President of Learning — Nov 2022 – Feb 2023

Learning Experience Design Manager — Sep 2021 – Nov 2022

Learning Experience Designer — Mar 2021 – Sep 2021

Four roles in two years, from designer to interim head of learning. I built the infrastructure that aligned care delivery, knowledge management, and clinical compliance in a fast-growing healthcare organization.

- Led the development of 100+ clinical eLearning modules in four months, with subject matter experts, to protect compliance and plan partnerships.
- Designed and launched the company's first intranet and knowledge system for 1,000+ employees.
- Grew the learning library from 30 to 10,000+ curated assets.
- Built standardized learner journeys that clarified roles and sped up onboarding across clinical teams.

APHSA (American Public Human Services Association)

2020 – 2021

Contract

Project Development Lead, eLearning — Dec 2020 – Dec 2021

I led the design and national launch of a federally aligned eLearning initiative for child welfare professionals across the United States.

- Directed end-to-end development of a two-hour immersive learning journey for the National Electronic Interstate Compact Enterprise (NEICE).
- Led change management and rollout to a 4,000-person frontline cohort.
- Set up measurement of engagement, satisfaction, and application impact, with high Net Promoter Scores.

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14 West

2019 – 2021

Baltimore, Maryland

Head of Learning and Development — Jul 2019 – Jan 2021

I drove learning innovation and digital transformation across a global digital publishing and marketing enterprise.

- Designed a business-aligned learning strategy that contributed to a 10 percent lift in growth metrics.
- Built workforce capability for the shift to one-to-one marketing and data-informed decisions.
- Deployed a global learning management system serving 5,000+ international learners.

Evolent Health

2013 – 2019

Arlington, Virginia

Director of Instructional Design — Feb 2017 – Feb 2019

Associate Director, Training Media Production, Clinical Education — Oct 2013 – Feb 2017

I led national learning initiatives that enabled clinical scale, operational readiness, and regulatory excellence in a fast-growing value-based care company.

- Rolled out enterprise learning strategy in 10+ new markets.
- Built structured clinical onboarding for 250+ clinical and operational staff.
- Tied learning to clinical KPIs to close skill gaps and improve care delivery outcomes.
- Embedded NCQA-aligned training into frontline education.

Erickson Living

2013

Catonsville, Maryland

Instructional Designer

Feb 2013 – Oct 2013

I partnered with senior leadership to define and operationalize the organization's critical leadership capabilities.

- Used design thinking to identify core leadership competencies and build programs around them.
- Designed leadership development and employment law programs that strengthened consistency and risk management.

Maxim Healthcare Group

2007 – 2012

Columbia, Maryland

Multimedia and Video Productions Manager, Learning and Development

Mar 2011 – Oct 2012

Instructional Designer and Multimedia Production Specialist

Oct 2007 – Mar 2011

Internet Resource Specialist, Training

Feb 2007 – Oct 2007

I built and scaled digital learning and multimedia infrastructure for a workforce of more than 65,000 employees nationwide.

- Built a multimedia function from the ground up, including the business case and budget.
- Created audience-specific content that reached a 90 percent view rate.
- Coordinated a statewide patient advocacy communication strategy with Government Affairs.

Cintas Corporation

2003 – 2006

Sales

New Business Development

Apr 2003 – May 2006

Where it started: a high-performing sales territory built on disciplined pipeline management and consultative selling, and an early lesson in tying every effort to results.

- Held an average of 20 prospect meetings a week and a 20 percent closing rate.
- Built long-term client relationships through follow-up, service, and accountability.

EXECUTIVE SCOPE

Where I *lead.*

Enterprise Learning Strategy

A learning and capability agenda tied to institutional goals, budgets, and measurable outcomes.

Leadership Education

Executive-led, results-based programs where leaders apply what they learn to real work.

Talent and Skills Architecture

Skills-based job architecture, talent review, succession, and internal mobility.

AI-Enabled Workforce

AI fluency, AI-built learning, and redesigning work as jobs change.

Measurement and Insight

KPIs, ROI, and dashboards that turn workforce signals into executive decisions.

Learning Design and Innovation

Modern learning built fast, from simulations to AI-built courses, with standards baked in.

EDUCATION

B.S., Social Sciences (in progress) — 2021 – 2027
University of Maryland Global Campus

A.A., Social Sciences — 2019 – 2025
Howard Community College

A.S., Multimedia and Web Design — 1999 – 2002
The Art Institutes, 120 credit hours

CERTIFICATIONS

Design Thinking and Innovation — 2021
University of Virginia

Adobe Captivate Certified Professional — 2019
Adobe

Training Certificate — 2013
Association for Talent Development

Video for Training — 2011
The Learning Guild

Designing Learning Certificate — 2007
Association for Talent Development

SPEAKING AND PUBLISHING

Speaker, mLearnCon — 2021
The Learning Guild

Speaker, Online Learning Conference — 2017
Training Magazine

Published, "Story Sync for the Classroom" — 2017
Training Magazine

Speaker, Annual Assembly of Hospice and Palliative Care — 2017
AAHPM

Speaker, mLearnCon — 2011
The Learning Guild